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Essentially, there are two ways in which gaming is used to increase the brand recognition and attract consumers. Firstly, it's used as a promotional tool—as a game on mobile phones provides entertainment and gives incentive to the users.

This year, we released the mobile game 'Jurm' prior to the film's launch. It was available to 10 million Reliance subscribers, free of cost, and had a 'meet the stars' contest for winners.

The other way is through royalty-based games, which is not yet a sustainable business model in India. Nevertheless, Bollywood has a huge fan following throughout India; and a game (video or Flash-enabled) based on movies is a great way to attract consumers.

Even for FMCGs (fast moving consumer goods), the uptake of games is remarkably high—when we launched the Thumbs-up promotional game, it was used by 3,50,000 users in the very first week! Gaming definitely helps reiterate the message of the brand.



ARE YOU

Leveraging games and technology to attract consumer eyeballs seems to be the new marketing mantra for films, FMCGs, and just about any new product or brand. We spoke to a few who have deployed this unique marketing idea



Imaging Vikram Khatare



Vishal Gondal
CEO
Indiagames Limited

The uptake for branded gaming content is high in India. As a matter of fact, half-a-million games are sold in the country every month.

We developed the *Kaun Banega Crorepati* game for users of Airtel recently, and a game on cricketer Zaheer Khan, to name a few. The time taken to develop a typical game can be anywhere between two to six months. These games are more popular among the younger net-savvy and mobile-using generation.

This is one trend that will continue to grow at a higher rate. It's an interactive way for producers to reach their audience, while carriers get fresh content and consumers get entertainment. The trend of using branded gaming content will definitely grow big in the future.